dorm dao | Oregon

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PENDLE

Pendle, $PENDLE Executive Summary

Pitch Executive Summary
02/17/2026

Pitch Summary	
Rating	Fairly Valued
Current Price	$1.22
Price Target	$1.00
Action Recommended	Sell
Recommended Size	1397 PENDLE
Native Staking	Yes

Key Statistics	
Network	Ethereum
Token Standard	EIP-5115
Category	DeFi
SubCategory	Yield-trading
Circulating Market Cap ($M)	164,787,348
Fully Diluted Market Cap ($M)	342,705,348
52 Week Price Range	$1.05 - $6.25
24-Hour Trading Volume	$21,840,353
Capital Deposited on Pendle	$2,567,302,238
Last Week Protocol Fees	$23,877

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Category Overview & Thesis

2026 is a “quality plus compliance” cycle for DeFi: markets are shaky, while regulatory clarity is improving around stablecoins. Broader market structure is pushing liquidity toward protocols possessing real cash-flow, strong risk controls, and either institutional or consume-grade UX. In a risk-off / selective-risk environment, the winners are protocols that maximize their revenue by being more efficient and attractive to traders.

Project Overviews

Pendle is a yield tokenization protocol that splits a yield-bearing asset into principal plus yield components (PT/YT) so users can buy/sell fixed yield vs variable yield and trade yield exposure like a real market. In 2025–2026, Pendle leaned into scaling and efficiency: recent updates highlight protocol growth and a token/incentive redesign intended to better align emissions with real contribution (TVL/fees) rather than “wasted” incentives. Solana matters here because low fees as well as high throughput make it easier to run yield strategies frequently (rebalancing, looping, hedging), and Solana DeFi’s growth (especially liquid staking and active trading) increases the set of yield-bearing assets Pendle-like products can monetize.

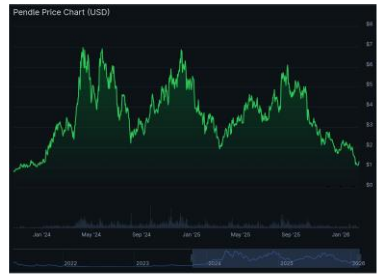
Project Thesis

Solana is structurally better positioned than competing Layer 1 networks to capture the next cycle of growth. Solana’s performance profile allows for active capital management, yield optimization, and real time coordination that are difficult to replicate on higher fee chains. As DeFi continues to mature and find product market fit throughout 2026, we believe positioning in more generalized position of an efficient and throughput L1, will protect our downside in the short-midterm.

Pendle Investment Report 02/24/26

Background on Pendle in our Portfolio

Pendle, a yield-trading platform established in 2020, is a token first pitched by OBG in 2023. At the time of the proposal, Pendle was a becoming a dominant player in Ethereum's fledgling defi ecosystem. Ultimately our thesis around the protocol's yield trading platform V2 played successfully, and we've since trimmed our position multitple times:



- 09/30/2024, 2097.895 $PENDLE, (261.37% ROI ETH)
- 10/29/2025, 524.47375 $PENDLE, (297.02$ ROI ETH)
- 1/12/2026, 1030.00 $PENDLE, (11.37% ROI ETH)

In late 2025, the venture capital team reevaluated Pendle, as the token was experiencing a significant drawdown in price from a local August top above $6.00. Due to this and Pendle's recent launching of their Boros platform, we believed we were entering at a price-level not really seen since pitching back in 2023.

Pendle has since introduced sPendle (to replace the older vePendle model), a new staking token with redisigned tokenomics to better align with the protocol's current roadmap. This upgrade is intented to address major limitations experienced with the vePendle system.

- vePendle required long lock-up periods (intented to promote long-term commitment)
- Non-transferable
- "Weekly vote-to-earn system required a deep understanding of DeFi and market dynamics to optimize rewards" - Pendle Team

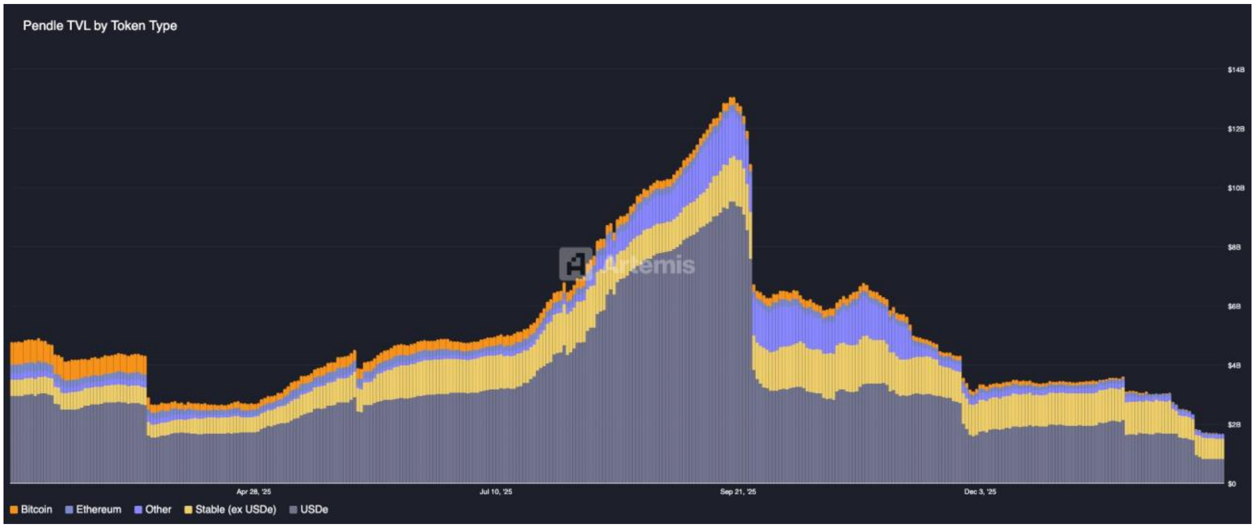
These factors ultimately contributed to a 20% participation rate in Pendle's DAO. Recognizing that many holders were choosing to not even stake, the team decided to pivot and launch a new token. Described as "much simpler," this system introduces a revamped revenue model - Pendle buybacks as opposed to revenue distribution, where Pendle tokens are distributed to eligible sPendle holders. While aiming to improve value accrual for holders, sPendle hopes to boost participation in the DAO to realistically 50%, with a dream of achieving 100% participation.

- 14-day lock period for withdrawals, replaces previous long-term staking model
- New voting system reduces emissions by ~30%.

Currently as of writing 94,245,971 is staked in Pendle, and $52,170 in fees has been collected since Feb. 11. Although many of the changes seen in sPendle can be seen as positive, issues such as low DAO participation and reduced TVL has lowered confidence in the protocol. Boros revenue is notably not going towards sPendle. The team has stated that this is intended to change once Boros reaches product market fit, but no timeline has been announced. With ~50 people on staff, growth relating to the development of Boros is the teams primary focus according to co-founder TN Lee.

DeFi in 2026

Overall the team and much of defi as a whole, recognize the challenges that still need to be overcome since the October 10th incident when over $19B was liquidated from markets. This crash particularly affected Ethena due to a depegging of USDe, Ethena's synthetic yield-bearing stablecoin. Although there is debate as to what exactly caused this crash, the macro effects hit Pendle especially hard.



Locked USDe in Pendle's ecosystem dropped around 90% in late 2025, from $9.5 billion to $825 million today following the maturity of 33 USDe pools and the conclusion of Ethena's Season 4 airdrop. This was a main trading strategy for many on the platform, who were able to leverage lending protocols such as Aave to recursively borrow USDe. When rates were averaging 12%APY in 2025, Pendle benefited, but macroeconomic narratives and overall bearishness in the market have changed this. Simply put, when yield's are high, Pendle is first in line, but the converse is also true.

NeoFi Tokens - % Return

Returns since 2026-01-01 00:00:00 UTC

Token Name	Return (%)
MORPHO	25.89
HYPE	20.67
SKY	13.56
AAVE	-13.97
CFG	-17.71
SYRUP	-23.82
ONDO	-25.06
ETHFI	-33.17
PENDLE	-35.75

10 rows Search...

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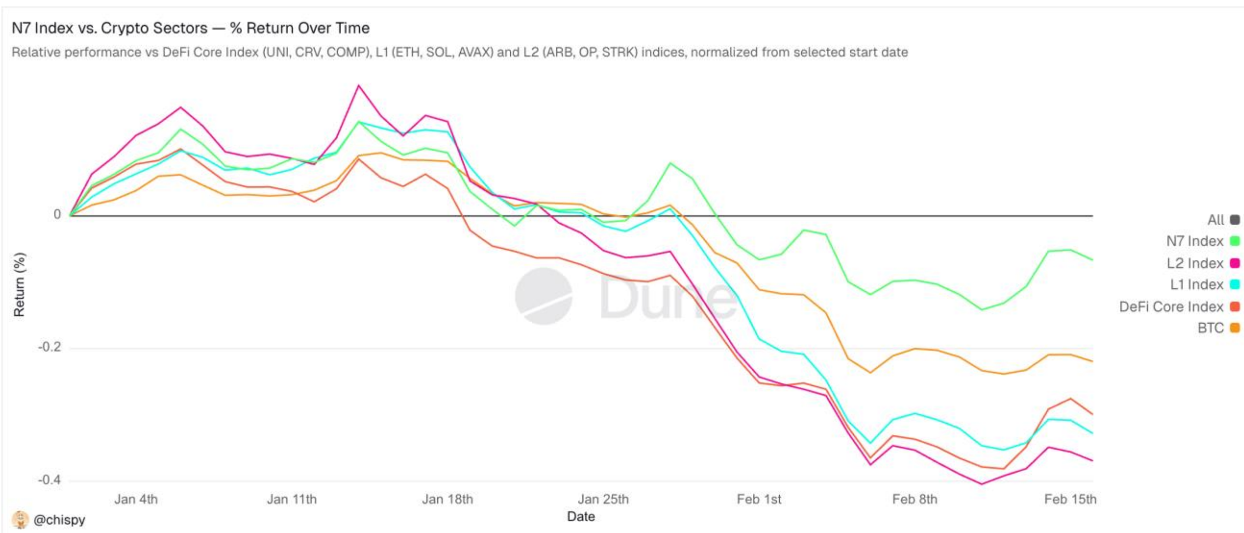
Looking forward, 2026 has its eyes on the movements of governmentsand how regulation will shape out. Off the back and promise of GENUIS, the US is currently working towards finalizing a draft for the CLARITY ACT. Larry Fink and Rob Goldstein of Blackrock believe "tokenization can greatly expand the world of investable assets beyond listed stocks and bonds," which falls perfectly into Pendle's narrative with Boros trading any form of yield. Institutional players such as JP Morgan, Fidelity, and Citi to name a few and experimenting with tokenization as seen in JPM Coin, Fidelity Digital Dollar, and Citi's 24/7 integrated token services. Furthermore in this period of reduced token prices, major DATs such as Blackrock's' IBIT, and StrategyB have added to their positions signaling continued confident in cryptocurrencies from traditional finance.

However there is a significant hurdle regarding CLARITY. An issue currently being debated is whether yield generation should be allowed on stablecoins (like USDe). Some banks and credit unions are fearful that this will cause individuals to withdraw their savings accounts creating a liquidity and lending crisis for traditional/local finance. Although studies such as one conducted by Lin William Cong state that this is a non-issue, alarms have been rang slowing the process for passing any meaningful regulation thus far. Regardless of the outcome, this has put Pendle, specifically V2 where trading yield is the product in a unique position.

Defi overall is at an inflection point as it moves towards maturity. In a moment where some are calling out the blockchain industry for not being “really decentralized,” much of the conversation today falls in what TN Lee said about Boros – that Defi needs to find product market fit before becoming decentralized. Safety is a major concern for regulators, as is compliance for businesses. Protocols moving in that direction are better positioned to benefit from a clearly regulatory framework. In this narrative, Boros which is hoping to tap into sectors beyond funding rates, could be a beneficiary of this trad-defi relationship.



Why Solana?

Solana stands out because it is built around execution rather than static settlement. The network is designed for environments where users and protocols interact constantly through trading, rebalancing, order updates, and payments. This matters as DeFi shifts away from passive yield and toward professional, strategy driven activity. On higher fee chains, frequent interaction quickly becomes uneconomical. On Solana, low and predictable transaction costs allow strategies to run continuously without fees eroding returns, creating a structural advantage that compounds as activity increases.

What strengthens the Solana case today is that it is no longer relying purely on speed as a headline metric. The protocol is actively evolving towards true market grade settlement. Their 2026 roadmap focuses on closing the gap between fast confirmations and irreversible finality. Alpenglow, a proposed redesign of consensus and networking, targets near instant finality in practice. If successful, this fundamentally changes risk assumptions for trading, payments, and real time applications by reducing settlement uncertainty and simplifying system design. Faster true finality tightens risk windows and makes Solana behave more like real time financial infrastructure than a batch settlement chain.

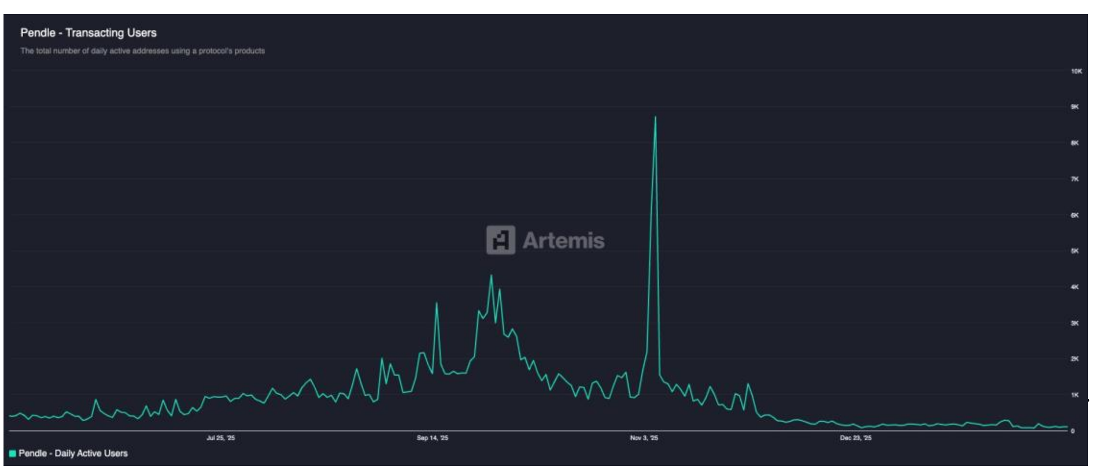
Solana is also attacking scalability at its most important bottleneck: the cost of common operations. Token transfers dominate network usage, and SIMD 0266 introduces a new token program designed to drastically reduce compute for those instructions. By lowering the cost of the most frequent actions on the network, Solana can scale usage without fees spiking during congestion. This directly supports high volume markets, consumer applications, and payment flows that would struggle on chains where execution costs rise sharply with demand.

Protocol risk has meaningfully improved alongside these upgrades. The introduction of Firedancer brings real client diversity and higher performance headroom, reducing historical concerns around single client dependence. Improvements in block building and execution quality through infrastructure like Jito's block assembly further strengthen Solana's suitability for sophisticated markets where predictability and fairness matter as much as throughput.

The argument for Solana is therefore not about one metric or one cycle. It is about alignment between where onchain activity is heading and what the protocol is being optimized to support. Low-cost execution, faster and more reliable settlement, improving resilience, and a roadmap centered on market structure position Solana as one of the few networks capable of supporting real time, high frequency financial activity at scale without breaking under load.

Pendle Thesis and Reasoning

In late spring 2025, Pendle sat at a $4.2 billion TVL, with a future built around their vePendle token capabilities. The utility was based on the market for tokenized Real-World Assets (RWA), in Pendles case, speculative trading on future yield. Pendles model allowed investors to turn their assets into a stable, yield bearing principle, or Principal Token (PT), and a token based on the speculative derivative on that yield bearing asset, a Yield Token (YT). Investors could hedge their risk on their yield, a utility that is unique in the DeFi space. By September '25, Pendles TVL grew to over $13 billion, a 67% in value over the span of 6 months. From an outside perspective, Pendle's yield generates were in high demand; clearly, they had filled a unique niche in the market that no other stablecoin protocol had managed to fill. Daily active users capped at 14.2k, a clear sign that the platform was a winner in the bullish market.



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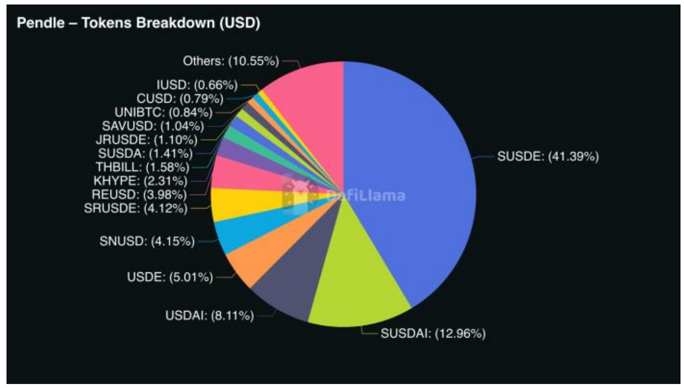
- TVL is down 82.2% to $2.357b.
- Fee-based revenue model generates volume multiples, however without usage there ceases to be value.

So, what happened? Was this simply a result of the bullish market taking Pendle down with it? Can Pendle see a rebound? The short answer is yes, but not without significant risk.

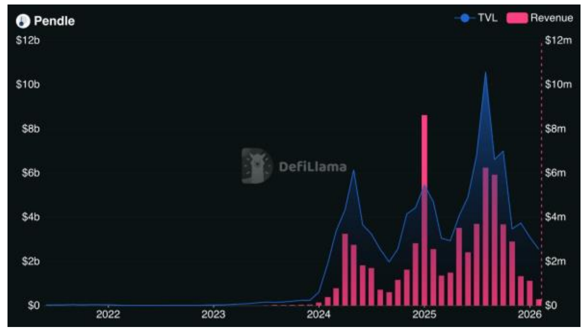


There is a secret within Pendles massive 2025 spike, and it involves Pendles strategic placement within a mercenary capital bootstrapping ecosystem. At the time of Pendles 2025 peak TVL, 49% of tokens within Pendle were Ethena synthetic stablecoin products. These products, such as USDe, are yielding stablecoins, whose yield is generated on ETH and BTC future derivatives. Using USDe and Pendle, investors found a recursive cycle through which yields could be heavily multiplied. A user would take their USDe to Pendle and receive their Principle and Yield Token. They would then take their principle to a liquidity market such as Aave, and put their principle up as collateral for liquidity at a borrowing rate. This liquidity would then be used to buy more USDe, and subsequently back to Pendle for more principle. The profit of this cycle was generated by the difference in USDe yield and liquidity market borrowing rates. Multiplying this difference by the number of recursions gives the stacked %APY the user would generate on their original investment. During Pendle's peak, USDe yield was roughly 12%, while Aave borrowing rates were at 6%. This meant that an investor who conducted this process 5 times would receive 30% APY off their original investment. However, as the market contracted, Ethereum derivative values collapsed, and borrowing rates spiked. The cycle of profitability disappeared, and unlocked users essentially liquidated their assets simultaneously.

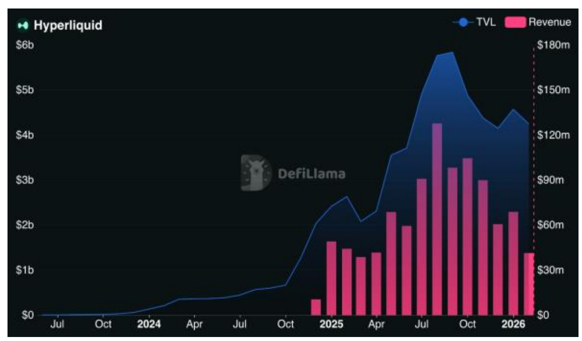
Even while Pendle was being pumped through this mega point system, they lost out on fee generating revenue as their products moved through multiple 3rd party platforms. This exposed a fundamental flaw in Pendle: **the volatility of their asset is layered into the volatility of many differing protocols, who experience differing market reactions.** This creates an ”Inception“ like pattern in their volatility: volatility within their volatility ,making Pendle a significant portfolio of risk. This being said, Pendle is still a platform with potential. Their newest product, Boros, allows for the trading of the tokenized equivalent of an Interest Rate Swap, the only platform in the space that gives this option. There is a key incentive to Boros, which is that for every $1 million in swap volume, Pendle generates approximately $745 in marginal revenue, a 340x monetized value from traditional IRS which generates only around $3. CEO TN Lee has stated that Pendle has allocated a separate, specialized team for the development of Boros, displaying team confidence in their product. However, for Boros to be adopted efficiently, it must be used by traders with massive capital and leverage. Unless Boros can attract intuitional investors willing to put up large, over the counter funds, Boros does not sit in a position of profitability. Along with this, revenue generated through Boros will not be used on $PENDLE buybacks, creating separation from the platforms' success to the value of their native token.

While Pendle may have a strategic market position, it has not seen a steady user basis from it's utility. Until Pendle can prove that it has market that is willing to consistently put up the capital needed to capitalize on its efficiency as a protocol, it will continue to be an inflammatory asset that turbulently swings with the overall market sentiment.

Pendle vs. Competitors



As aforementioned, Pendle serves a very niche placement in the DeFi space: no other large platform allows for yield derivative trading. However, Pendle's utility as a DeFi protocol relies on the fact that it is the niche for this subset, and that it can conduct transactions in the most efficient manner. As a trading platform, Pendle is in competition with other large-scale trading platforms, such as HyperLiquid and Coinbase. HyperLiquid in specific has seen large scale growth due to its implementation in RWA trading. Their HIP-3 proposal now allows for the trading of tokenized commodities indexes, which have seen massive growth with the popularity in Gold and Silver as macro performance assets.



HIP-3 also allows for the creation of virtually any perpetual market, such as the trading of tokenized Tesla, Nvidia, and NASDAQ futures, just so long as there is a consumer base. In theory, a third-party builder could generate a fund tracking yield perpetual; However, HyperLiquid's trading markets are currently rate capped, allowing for only 1% asset value to increase every 3 seconds. For massive spikes in volatile assets such as yield margins, these funds cannot accurately track derivative appreciation in real time, making them redundant to traders. Both have similar TVL, with HyperLiquid's current lying around $4.6 billion and Pendle's at $2.375 billion. HyperLiquid currently holds 45% of the perpdex market share, while Pendle's niche placement in the yield market gives it over 80% of the total market share. It should be apparent however that as an asset, HyperLiquid massively outperforms, with over $1.34 billion in annualized fees, compared to humble $45 million. Where Pendle wins out on HyperLiquid is it's foundational placement in the yield trading sector of the broader DeFi market. Pendle's protocols are heavily intergraded with debt swap platforms, which favor Pendle's high yield tokens, with over $4 million in Pendle's principal being held as lending collateral. However, the two platforms interact constructively for those wanting to hedge their speculation on future asset prices. Traders invest a synthetic yield bearing stablecoin pegged to the price of a L1 such as ETH or BTC. To hedge the possible loss on the value of their Yield Token, they can take on a short perpetual on that pegged asset through HyperLiquid. The two positions result in market neutrality, if the price speculative yield on the asset drops due to volatility on its peg, the shorted perpetual through HyperLiquid will cover the losses. Otherwise, the price on the YT grows in value, passively stacking %APY for the trader. The two platforms are both respective players in the future of decentralized trading; however, Pendle is yet to develop their market placement to generate the volumes necessary to be comparable.

Solana vs. Competitors

Solana has underperformed recently, with SOLUSD down **55.03%** versus **25.80%** for ETHUSD and **45.86%** for XRPUSD over the same window, so the buy case cannot be framed as momentum. The reason to consider SOL anyway is that price performance is different from product performance, and Solana's advantage is concentrated in execution of heavy crypto activity that depends on low fees and fast finality. Relative to Ethereum, L1 costs still restrict frequent interaction and while L2s reduce fees, they fragment liquidity and user experience across rollups, which matters for high velocity trading and rebalancing. Relative to Tron, the edge is not being the default stablecoin rail but being the place where stablecoins become productive through DeFi trading and strategies. Relative to Sui and other newer L1s, Solana's edge is ecosystem depth and liquidity, which is harder to replicate than raw throughput claims. If Solana continues capturing the highest frequency behaviors in crypto while price lags ETH and XRP, that creates upside asymmetry because the market is discounting SOL more heavily than its onchain activity would suggest.

Chain	MCAP	Stablecoin Supply	Revenue (Jan. 2026)	Top Protocols
	$49.5B	$15.4B	$20.5M	Pump (Memecoins), Jupiter (DEX), Phantom (wallet)
	$240.5B	$160.02B	$7.8M	Aave (Lending), Sky (yield-bearing stables), Flashbots (MEV tools)
	$26.9B	$84.68B	$13.4M	TRONSAVE (Services), JustLend (Lending), SUN (Swap-farming)
	$3.8B	$560.86M	$786.3K	NAVI (Lending), Dip Coin (DEX), Bluefin (DEX)

Sources: CoinGecko, Artemis & DefiLlama

Pendle's Tailwinds and Headwinds

Pendle's value is heavily correlated with the value of market derivatives. Synthetic stablecoins such as Ethena's synthetic products still make ~47% of Pendle's current token breakdown. This means that Pendle is heavily exposed to the derivative price of Bitcoin and Ethereum, sitting upstream to market movement. In a bullish market this could lead to a spike in Pendle value, as its inherent yield stacks in the value. This has happened before; In late Spring 2024, Pendle saw a very different token makeup as today. About 4.6 billion of its then 6.3 billion market cap was held directly in either ETH or wETH. Between May 15th-and

May 19^{h} 2024, Pendle began ticked up 22.25% while ETH was at a 3-month low. Between May 20^{th} and May 22^{nd} ETH saw an increase in price of around 30%. There is definitely a speculative aspect to this, and Pendle's December hike was directly parallel with a day-to-day hike in ETH price. What this shows is that Pendle gains correlate well with the market sentiment, often seeing higher day-to-day growth rates than their complements. During the next bull market, it would not be a surprise to see Pendle price hike. However, it should be noted that Pendle's high volatility exposure will lead to a sharp decline, prior to that in the general market. This reversal scenario historically sees even faster declines. Between July 27^{th} and September 19^{th} 2025, Pendle saw a 48% increase in both TVL and price. On October 1^{st}, that entire gain was cleared. This is also a regular trend, as seen by the 39.7% decrease between December 9^{th}, 2025^{th} and January 1^{st}, 2026. Pendle sees sharp speculative gains, but sees even sharper pitfalls, typically before the overall market. The issue here is liquidation speed; even though sPendle allows for a 14-day locking period option, investors must trust stability within those 14 days, which historically has a high probability of turbulence.

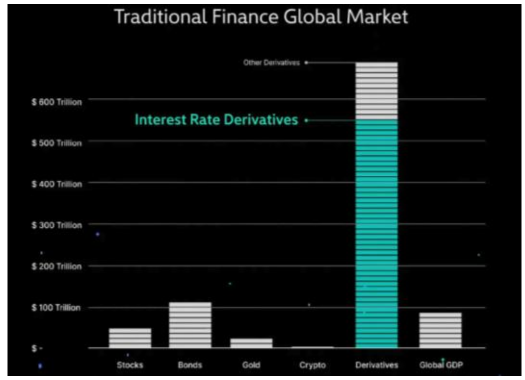
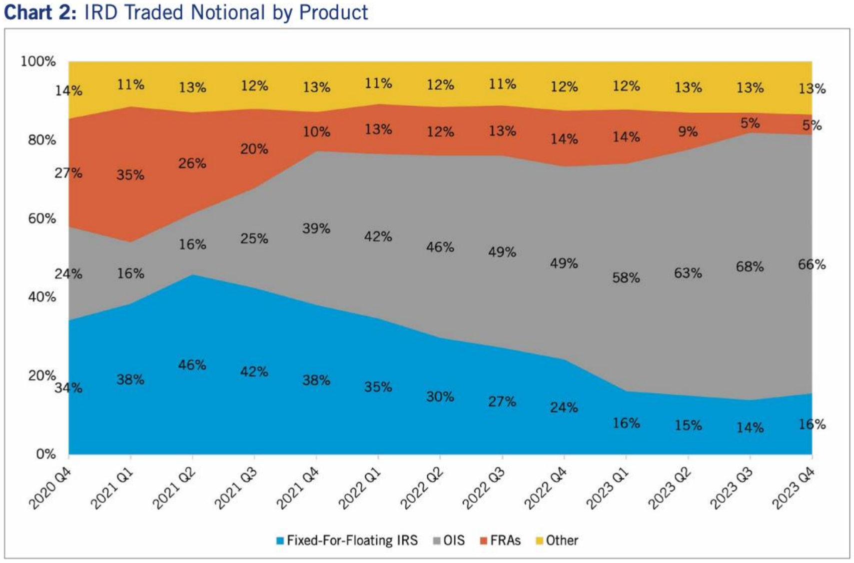


Chart 2: IRD Traded Notional by Product



Source: DTCC SDR

Portfolio Strategy

We expect Pendle Finance to remain the dominant onchain yield derivatives platform, maintaining >80% market share within its niche. While its explosive rise in 2025 was largely driven by recursive synthetic stablecoin carry trades, primarily via Ethena USDe, this unwind appears to be cyclical as opposed to structural. Similar dislocations were observed historically, notably during the stETH leverage cycle which Pendle recovered from during broader yield expansion. The protocol is now transitioning alongside a maturing DeFi market through:

- sPendle tokenomics redesign: reduced emissions, simplified staking, buyback-based value accrual
- Launch of Boros: expanding into funding-rate and rate-derivative trading
- Multi-chain expansion: reducing Ethereum-only dependency

The core question is whether Pendle can successfully expand beyond a protocol dependent on mercenary carry flows into a structural rate-trading venue embedded in decentralized derivatives markets. Decentralized perpetual exchange volume tripled in 2025, rising from ~$4.1 trillion to over $12 trillion annualized. In tradfi, derivatives volumes significantly exceed spot volumes, and we expect that relationship to increasingly carry over onchain.

Fund Recommendation

While Pendle represents a high growth potential position, Solana represents a broader layer-1 ecosystem bet with diversified demand drivers. Solana's investment case is not dependent on yield or funding rate expansion. Instead, value accrues from:

- Application layer growth & developer ecosystem (notably seen in the success of platforms such as Pump.fun, Jupiter, Phantom, & Kamino)
- Increasing stablecoin settlement
- Low-cost, high-throughput execution advantages
- Growing institutional adoption and engagement

If Boros successfully captures funding rate trading and broader yield curve speculation, then we see Pendle transitioning from a niche yield protocol into a rate infrastructure layer. This will greatly expand its total addressable market beyond synthetic stablecoins and carry loops.

- Boros must demonstrate sustained volume and institutional participation
- Revenue generated from Boros must eventually accrue to token holders

Without those factors, however, Pendle remains highly cyclical to the broader marbeta sensitive Pendle should be looked at not as a defensive allocation, but as a convex derivatives-cycle trade where expanding funding-rate environments and high-yield narratives benefit Pendle asymetrically.

Where Pendle monetizes volatility within yield markets, Solana monetizes overall onchain activity. This distinction matters in sideways or moderately bullish environments such as what we are experiencing in early 2026. Solana's broader market base may offer more resilient price action relative to Pendle's reflexive yield exposure. Prior cycles show that Pendle underperforms in bear markets and outperforms in bull markets.

In this case we are proposing the following:

- Liquidate our Pendle position purchased 12/24/25
- Swap that position to increase our allocation in Solana & lower cost-basis

We intend this swap to Solana to act as a short to midterm risk-off position.

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